Context. In military history, there is a distinction between strategic and tactical surprise. It is often difficult to conceal a strategy being followed, but choosing tactically when and where to attack can be easier to change. It may be useful to think of strategy as the *macro* and the tactics as the *micro*.

Tactical \ Strategic	Known	Unknown
Known	Both known (routine)	**Strategic surprise** You know tactics but not intent
Unknown	**Tactical surprise** You known intent but not execution	**Full surprise** Unknown intent *and* execution

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Initial Attempt. My initial attempt to construct such a matrix was not so good, but is in some ways simpler. It doesn't consider the interaction of states (e.g., you can have tactical *and* strategic surprise).

Foreknowledge \ Scope	Tactical	Strategic
Known	You knew the timing and the target; likely routine	You knew what was coming strategically; good intelligence
Unknown	**Tactical surprise** They do something whose timing and/or target is unknown to you	**Strategic surprise** They do something you didn't know about strategically

NB—: States can interact in complex ways. You can experience tactical surprise (i.e., London bombings) without strategic surprise (chatter of terrorist incident was known). Likewise, you can experience strategic surprise but know something is coming. If you're very unlucky, you can experience both kinds of surprise at once. So at any given time, you can exist in multiple states in the matrix depicted above.